

KHAN'S CAN DO-ISMS

"I've heard about my brand. I'm manipulative, I run after money. Whatever. My logic is I'm a brand because I put passion into my work."

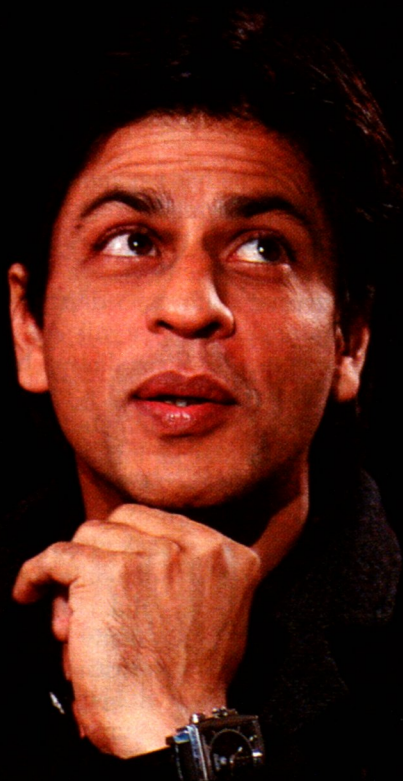
"I'M A BIT OF A FAKIR. I WEAR THE NICEST CLOTHES BECAUSE THEY'RE GIVEN TO ME. I DON'T THINK OF FOOD, AIR AND WATER AS NECESSITIES."

"I never do a film for money. You can buy me for everything but a film. Films I do for love."

"I believe in trying something new. The more people tell me I'm wrong, the more I believe I can do it."

"You have to believe in something. I believe my children are untainted. If they say I'm the best I am."

"I've seen death from very close quarters. After that, failure doesn't scare you. Only if you fail will you succeed."



Rs 75 cr
annual earnings
from 15 brand
endorsements

close friends Jay Mehta and Juhi Chawla look on, his friend Dhoot, sitting meekly in a corner of his plush suite, calls him a natural-born entrepreneur. Shah Rukh balks at the description, but in effect taking risks is the underpinning of his life since the time he acted as an anti-hero in Abbas Mustan's *Baazigar*—a role rejected by Salman Khan—and in Yash Chopra's *Darr*, a part turned down by Aamir Khan. "Korbo, Lorbo, Jeetbo", the three Bengali words inscribed in his team's anthem (and dreamed up by director Sujoy Ghosh for music director duo Vishal-Shekhar), describe his life best. As he puts it: "We have to do, to fight and to win, or die trying." It's a work ethic that has seen him become India's biggest endorsement machine, with 15 brands at the last count, each earning him a pay cheque of Rs 5 crore.

This in addition to stray assignments like launching the new logo of Shoppers' Stop recently, for which he was paid Rs 1.5 crore for a couple of hours of work. "When I started building my house, I realised I wasn't going to do bad films for money. The opportunity cost was too high. It was a Keynesian matter of demand being fulfilled by supply. I decided to dance at weddings or endorse brands for it," he says. That has paid off. The 20,000-sq-ft, Rs 100-crore fairytale seaside mansion to which he has added a wing to house his office, gym and a den which can accommodate makeshift television sets (last year for *Kaun Banega Crorepati 3* and this year for *Paanchvi Pass*) is built entirely with his blood and sweat—and he is not always being ironic when he describes it as the most famous address in India, yes even more than Rashtrapati Bhavan.

His competitive spirit is legendary. He hates losing even to friends in board games like *Articulate* and *Trivial Pursuit*. "A lot of people think I live in a comfort zone. I do a lot of things not on a whim but on an inner voice that tells me why not," he says, sounding like his biggest fan. Anything can be a trigger. In the case of IPL, it was the criticism of appearing at cricket matches to market his production, *Om Shanti*